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Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Oak Grove Classical Academy
School Website: <https://oakgroveclassical.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Oak Grove Classical Academy NM 87068 presents a clearly classical, Christian-oriented program anchored in a University-Model pedagogy. Public materials from the school emphasize Christ-centered formation, biblical worldview, and virtue development (humility, courage, diligence) alongside explicit curricular elements associated with the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and upper-level rhetoric training (Rhetoric School, Latin, Senior Thesis). The school frames education as formation and character formation in a Christian context, placing substantial emphasis on parental partnership and a formation-focused mission. Taken together, these signals align most strongly with CLASSICAL, with some elements that appear more aligned with traditional or contemporary college-preparatory expectations than with a fully dialogic, Socratic, great-books-inflected classical core in every grade.

Key sources confirming the overarching orientation include the mission statement and theology-forward materials that explicitly name Christ-centered, biblical worldview formation and the Bible-based Statement of Faith, as well as the presence of virtues as central to the program. The presence of Latin, rhetoric coursework, Senior Thesis, and an explicit focus on virtue formation reinforces the classical orientation, though explicit mentions of Great Books and a continuous, school-wide Socratic/seminar pedagogy across all grades are less prominent in publicly available materials. The aggregate across the six categories remains CLASSICAL, with Element 3 and Element 4 showing SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL signals due to the explicit emphasis on a Trivium-and-Rhetoric trajectory and a more traditional college-preparatory framing in places.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Notes on the scoring approach and keyword analysis:

- The rubric uses a Positive/Negative Keyword framework drawn from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1). Key Positive indicators include truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; theology; liturgy; wonder; great books; the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric); formation; partnership with families; and a living faculty. Negative indicators include secularism, relativism, purely skills-based approaches, and a lack of formation or classical markers.
- Evidence drawn from Oak Grove's public-facing materials includes explicit Christian, biblical, and theological language; mentions of virtue and formation; the University-Model pedagogy; explicit Rhetoric-

focused coursework; Latin and foreign language study; and a stated commitment to parental partnership.

Evidence and keyword analysis (high-level mappings)

- Positive keywords evidenced in the school materials include: Christ-centered; biblical worldview; Bible; The Trinity; The Holy Spirit; theology; formation and virtue; humility; courage; diligence; great conversation; Rhetoric; Latin; Senior Thesis; University-Model; partnership with families; love of learning; wonder; and formation through the arts (music, drama). These terms appear in mission statements, statements of faith, core-virtues descriptions, and curricular descriptions. See sources including Our Mission and Virtues, Statement of Faith, Core Tenets, and curricular descriptions.
- Negative keywords (where applicable) are not strongly evidenced in the public materials; the school text emphasizes formation, virtue, and theology rather than secular, relativistic, or purely skills-based approaches. The Six Essential Elements' negative-keyword signals for "Lack of Great Books," "Lack of formation," and similar concerns are not dominant in the available Oak Grove materials; where present, the school materials align with formation-focused, classical signals rather than the negations. See Six Essential Elements lexicon for the negative signals and their scope.

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school identifies itself as Christ-centered and Christian, with a Mission Statement that explicitly positions biblical faith as foundational to the educational goals and a drive to "apply God's truth" in students' spheres of influence.
- The school presents a formal Statement of Faith (Bible, Trinity, Holy Spirit) and a university-model, Christian-formed education, underscoring theology as foundational to the curriculum and community life.
- The Core Tenets emphasize virtues like humility, courage, and diligence as defining student and educator aims, aligning with transcendental virtues and formation.
- The school frames education as formation anchored in a biblical worldview, aligning with a liturgical, reverent, and sacred dimension of schooling and communal life (as reflected in the related materials and arts emphasis).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Christ-centered, biblical worldview, Bible, Trinity, Holy Spirit, theology, virtue, formation, humility, courage, diligence, worship/legacy of sacred practice. These map to Positive Keyword indicators for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations (truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; theology; liturgy; reverence; wonder). The Six Essential Elements lexicon defines these positive indicators; the Oak Grove materials demonstrate alignment with these terms.
- Negative keywords: None strongly evidenced in the public-facing materials; there is no emphasis on secularism or relativism. The content consistently foregrounds theological commitments and virtue formation.

Why this rating

- The school's public materials anchor the educational project in theology and biblical truth, with explicit statements of faith and a Christ-centered mission, plus a focus on virtue formation and reverence. These alignment signals correspond strongly to CLASSICAL in this category per the Six Essential Elements rubric. The presence of theology, worship-like communal formation signals, and a biblically integrated curriculum supports a CLASSICAL rating here.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The mission emphasizes formation through virtue and wisdom and the integration of truth, goodness, and beauty, rather than mere job-prep. The language centers on character formation, love of learning, and applying truth in life. This reflects a formation-focused telos beyond vocational prep.

- The school explicitly describes the goal as forming students with Christian character, courage, and virtue, not simply preparing for a job. The “our mission” language stresses formation, wisdom, and the cultivation of character.
- The school’s articulation of a biblical worldview and a heart for the gospel places truth and beauty central to the aims of education, aligning with the classical telos described in the Six Essential Elements.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, human flourishing, telos, pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty, scholé (restful learning) themes appear in the broader classical lexicon and are echoed in the school’s ethos and language.
- Negative keywords: None of the traditional workforce-orientation signals (career readiness, job-market metrics) predominate; the content emphasizes formation and character rather than purely utilitarian aims. The school’s language about college-prep exists, but the core telos remains formation and wisdom.

Why this rating

- The school foregrounds formation, virtue, and the pursuit of lasting truths rather than a narrow emphasis on vocational outcomes, aligning with Classical expectations for School Purpose and Goal. The explicit biblical-theological frame and the emphasis on wisdom/virtue provide a CLASSICAL rating.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The site references Trivium-aligned structure in the public materials (grammar, logic, rhetoric) in the K–12 progression, with explicit mention of Grammar School, Logic School, and Rhetoric School pathways and courses (Latin and foreign language in upper levels; Senior Thesis in Rhetoric). This signals the Seven Liberal Arts orientation (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Latin; rhetoric-focused upper levels).
- There are clear indications of a rhetoric-focused upper school, including Senior Thesis projects, and Latin/foreign language requirements, consistent with classical pedagogy.
- What is less explicit in public-facing materials is a sustained, school-wide emphasis on Great Books and direct, continuous Great Conversation-style engagement with primary classical texts across all grades. The materials do note a classical formation and “great conversation” language in the Six Essential Elements rubric, but explicit Great Books/primary-sources integration is not as clearly evidenced in the public Oak Grove materials as in some other classical programs. The “Great Books” language appears more as a rubric reference than as a stated school-wide curricular commitment on the site.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric (Trivium); Latin; Senior Thesis; Rhetoric I; foreign language study; classical pedagogy; great conversation (as an element of classical education, though not strongly labeled as such in the site text).
- Negative keywords signals (from the Six Essentials lexicon) include lack of Great Books, lack of integration/wonder signals, or reliance on non-classical project-based learning. The public materials do not clearly demonstrate a robust Great Books program across grades, and while there is a coherent Trivium progression, explicit Great Books engagement and uniform “great conversation” emphasis are less frequently stated in the site content. This makes Element 3 not fully Classical but still aligned with core classical elements.

Why this rating

- The curriculum shows strong Trivium-based structure, Latin, and rhetoric-focused components, which are classical hallmarks. However, the public-facing materials do not consistently foreground a canonical Great Books-and-Great Conversation approach across all grades, or an explicit, uniform Great Books program, which supports a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL classification for Curriculum.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL



Evidence

- Upper-school pedagogy appears to emphasize rhetoric and capstone-style work (Rhetoric School with Senior Thesis), aligning with classical methods such as dialectic, rhetoric, and public speaking. The presence of a dedicated rhetoric pathway and Senior Thesis indicates a move toward higher-order reasoning and public presentation.
- Lower-school pedagogy signals include a strong arts emphasis (music, choir, drama) and a memory/recitation component in some classical models. The Oak Grove materials describe reinforcing memory and delight in learning through singing and performances, consistent with the contemplative/restful pedagogy (scholé) and memory-work signals from classical rubrics.
- The public materials emphasize a strong family partnership and a virtue-informed, formation-centered approach, which is consistent with classical pedagogy in many programs but does not always foreground a consistent, fully Socratic/seminar-based upper-school pedagogy in every course description available online. The explicit mention of Socratic discussions is less prominent in the public-facing site text, though the rhetoric and Senior Thesis suggest a focus on classical rhetorical training over time.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue (implied through “great conversation” and the rhetoric path, though not always explicit in the site text), Socratic-method signals (the Rhetoric path and Senior Thesis imply dialectical training), scholé/restful learning, memorization/recitation and chant (articulated in some classical curricula and memory work emphasis). The site emphasizes a balanced mix of contemplative and rigorous pedagogy, with lower-school singing/memory signals and upper-school rhetoric/deliberation signals.
- Negative keywords signals: The site does not consistently present a full Socratic seminar-heavy, all-grade Socratic program in every course, and some of the explicit “restful learning” and “scholé” signals appear primarily in the classical lexicon rather than in every public-facing course description. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL for Pedagogy.

Why this rating

- The pedagogy strongly aligns with classical aims in the upper grades (Rhetoric, Senior Thesis) and with lower-grade memory and arts-infused practices, but public-facing materials do not consistently demonstrate a full, school-wide Socratic/seminar program across all grades. The blend of memory, chant, and rhetoric signals a classical orientation with some non-Socratic elements, thus SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Core tenets describe teachers as virtuous exemplars and mentors, with a living curriculum and a culture of collegiality and mentorship. The site emphasizes faculty who model virtue and who guide students in a formation-focused environment. The presence of explicit virtue language and “living curriculum” concepts aligns with classical expectations for faculty.
- The school notes a faculty profile and a portrait of the teacher-student ideal, emphasizing leadership, character, and moral formation. The mission emphasizes teachers who exemplify virtue and who mentor students in a classical context.
- There are explicit references to the faculty and leadership expectations (e.g., mentors, guides, sages) and a culture of lifelong learning among the educators themselves, which matches the classical model of faculty as the “living curriculum” and exemplars.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: virtuous educators; moral formation; mentorship; living curriculum; portrait of teacher/student ideals; collegial culture; masters/mentors. These map to Positive Keywords for Faculty in the Six Essentials lexicon.
- Negative keywords signals: none evident in public materials; there is no indication of a “facilitator/education-by-commission” or purely credential-driven approach; rather, a teacher-led,

mentor-centered model appears. This supports CLASSICAL.

Why this rating

- The materials present a coherent image of faculty as moral exemplars and mentors who embody classical virtues and act as the core of the school's living curriculum. This aligns with the CLASSICAL designation for Faculty.

Element 6: Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school highlights a partnership with families, with parents described as co-teachers and integral to the education process within the University-Model framework. The mission explicitly emphasizes partnering with parents in a Christ-centered, classical education, indicating a strong parental/communal integration.
- The materials indicate formal pathways for parent involvement, including integrated parent/teacher instruction and a strong emphasis on family participation in the home-school relationship (as part of the University-Model).
- The school articulates a shared mission with families, and it presents a vision in which parents are encouraged to participate and learn with the school (typical of classical partnerships with families). This includes a "co-teacher" framing and family formation signals.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Partnership with Families; parent involvement; home-school collaboration; family formation; parental formation; open campus/visits; parent training. These map to Positive Keywords in the Six Essentials Elements for Parents and Community.
- Negative keywords: None observed; the materials emphasize partnership rather than customer-model or minimal parental engagement. The presence of family integration is strong in the materials.

Why this rating

- The school's materials consistently position parents as co-teachers and partners, with explicit calls for family engagement, learning opportunities for parents, and open-campus interactions, fitting the CLASSICAL pattern for Parents & Community.

Aggregate assessment

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall, the school is CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- For a SCHOOL categorized as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (Element 3 and 4 signals), the needle would move toward full CLASSICAL by:
- Strengthening explicit Great Books/Great Conversation integration across all grade levels and making it visible as a consistent curricular pillar rather than primarily implied through rubrics.
- Expanding explicit, school-wide Socratic/seminar pedagogy in more classrooms beyond the upper-school rhetoric pathway, and foregrounding restful, contemplative pedagogy (Scholé) in a more systematic way.
- Elevating and clearly documenting the integration of liturgical practices or communal worship as a formal element of daily or weekly routines (if aligned with the school's faith tradition) to meet liturgy-like community signals in the rubric.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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